



SHOCK AND AWE

Dricus du Plessis's win against Sean Strickland **sets the tone** for Ultimate Fighting Championship this year.

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UFC 297 came to a controversial close as Dricus du Plessis was crowned the new undisputed middleweight champion after a split decision win against Sean Strickland.

Given how the five rounds had panned out, fans and experts were surprised when du Plessis was the one with his hand raised. Until the final moments of the fifth round, it had appeared that Strickland had the advantage, maintaining a

Surprise move: Fans and pundits were taken aback after Bruce Buffer, the announcer, declared Dricus du Plessis the winner due to the manner in which the five rounds panned out. AFP

higher significant-strike rate.

"I had it two-to-two going into the last round, and I thought Strickland won the last round. Guys who were sitting at the same table had it the other way. It's one of those tight fights," said UFC CEO Dana White after the event.

The dust from the previous event has barely settled, and the next major UFC event is already on the horizon. UFC 298, slated to take place on February 18, boasts an exciting lineup of fights, including the main event featuring Alexander Volkanovski, the current

« Volkanovski, nicknamed 'The Great', has successfully defended his featherweight belt five times »